7/8/2025 - Proceeding of Motion of Commission - 25-E-0072, 25-G-0073

STATE OF NEW YORK

PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

CASE 25-E-0072 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for ELECTRIC Service.

CASE 25-G-0073 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for GAS Service.

PUBLIC STATEMENT HEARING

DATE: JULY 8, 2025

LOCATION: Borough of Manhattan Community College
199 Chambers Street
New York, New York 10007

BEFORE: ALJ TARA KERSEY
ALJ DAKIN LECAKES

Reported by Ildiko Nyarai

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(The hearing commenced at 6:00 p.m.)

A.L.J. KERSEY: Good evening. We are on the record. I call cases 25-E-0072 proceeding on the Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York Inc. for Electric Service, and case 25-G-0073 proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York Inc. for Gas Service.

My name is Tara Kersey, and with me is chief administrative law Judge Dakin LeCakes. I, along with Judge James Costello and Judge Nicholas Planty (phonetic) have been assigned for the Department of Public Service to lead these rate cases. Chief administrative Judge LeCakes is with me to today to preside over this particular public statement hearing held on behalf of the New York State Public Service Commission regarding the proposed changes in the electric and gas delivery rates and practices of the Consolidated Edison Company of New York.

Con Edison filed amendments to its

electric and gas tariffs schedules on January 31st, 2025, proposing to increase its annual electric and gas delivery revenues for the 12-month period ending December 31st, 2026. It -- as of its April 10th, 2025, updated testimony, Con Edison proposes to increase its electric delivery revenues by approximately $1.6 billion and its natural gas delivery revenues by approximately $349 million. The actual bill impacts of these proposed changes on any particular customer class will vary based upon revenue allocation and rate design.

By letter dated June 24th, 2025, Con Edison filed a notice of impending settlement negotiations involving all participating parties. If settlement negotiations are successful, the parties to the settlement would file a joint proposal to be considered by the Commission. Under New York State law, the Public Service Commission must consider the utilities' proposals and may adopt or reject them in whole or in part or may modify them.

At this time, the commission must decide these cases by December 30th, 2025; however, that date may be subject to further extension.

Regardless of how these cases proceed, the Public Service Commission will make the final decision regarding the company's terms and conditions for providing electric and gas service. This hearing is being held so you can provide your comments on Con Edison's proposals for the Commission's consideration. In making its decision, the Commission will consider the evidentiary record in these cases and the comments made at this hearing.

The Public Service Commission has seven members -- the chairperson Rory Christian -- and six commissioners: James Alesi, David Valesky, John Maggiore, Uchenna Bright, Denise Sheehan, and Radina Valova.

The court reporter here will prepare a transcript of the hearing which will be included in the record of these proceedings. Statements you make today will become part of the record. When it is ready, the transcript will be available for public view on the Department of Public Service's website. Today's hearing is not a question-and-answer session; we are here only to listen to your comments. However, if you do have any questions or concerns

related to your service, Con Edison has representatives here, and they have materials that provide a dedicated phone number and email for customers to get assistance related to specific customer service and billing inquiries. You can obtain these materials on a table near where you checked in. We have members of our office of consumer services department here, and they can assist you with questions or complaints as well regarding your utility service.

If you do not wish to speak at today's hearing but you would like your views included in the record, there are other ways to comment. You can submit comments on the Department's website, by regular mail or by telephone. Information regarding these alternative methods is available from the Department's Office of Consumer Services staff, and again, they're located at the table near the door by the turnstile where you came in.

Regardless of how the comments are submitted, they will be given equal consideration by the Commission. According to the secretary's notice for this event, comments must be received by November

21st, 2025, to ensure the Commission is able to consider them prior to the final decision. If you'd like to make a statement here today and you have not done so, please fill out a registration card. The cards are available at the table with our outreach staff. I will call the speakers up by using the cards in the order in which they were received.

Please speak slowly and clearly so that the court reporter can accurately capture your statement for the record. We also ask that you please leave the microphone on the stand as if able where it is to pick up your voice for the sound system.

Our first speaker this evening is Hannah Leverenz. Good evening.

MS. LEVERENZ: Good evening. Can you hear me well?

A.L.J. KERSEY: Yeah. Absolutely.

MS. LEVERENZ: Thank you both for being here. My name is Hannah, and I am here because Con Ed is once again trying to raise our utility bills, and enough is enough. They're asking for around an 11 percent increase for electricity and 13

percent for gas, so breaking that down, a homeowner whose current average monthly bill is $200 would see their utility cost rise by $23 per month or nearly $275 per year. That is just for electric, and that's not even including proposed increases to the average Con Edison gas bill, and not even including the spiking prices that they charge for peak times when people desperately need services.

This isn't just a one-time thing; Con Ed has also raised our rates for three years in a row. Con Ed says it's for clean energy and infrastructure upgrades, but if anything, our service has gotten worse and worse. New Yorkers are seeing more blackouts, more outages, and slower response times. In just the past few weeks, Con Ed left tens of thousands of New Yorkers in the dark during a heat wave. At one point, 6,000 people in Brooklyn were without power, and Con Edison responded by lowering voltage and handing out dry ice.

But once again, their lack of investment building reliable infrastructure put profits in front of people and led to this. Since 2022, bills have gone up significantly. The average

monthly gas heating bill rose from $205 to 253 or more than $50 a month. We've already seen delivery rates climb under the last three year's rate increase plan approved in 2020 -- or maybe that's 2023, my apologies.

Despite these ballooning costs, there had been no measurable improvement in our service. Instead, like I said before, we've seen blackouts, poor communication, increased outages, and a complete lack of public accountability. I also want to point out that in Con Ed in New York City and Westchester is a monopoly, so we can't shop around. We can't switch providers, there's no competition, and therefore, there's no incentive for them to do better, only to charge more.

Just to give you some statistics about their profits, which I'm sure you are both aware of, Con Ed made around $791 million in profits in just the first quarter of 2025. Their total profit last year was over $12 billion, and their CEO alone made around $16.8 million. Meanwhile, New Yorkers are skipping meals to keep their lights on and the air conditioning on during this heat wave.

We're calling on the Public Service Commission to say no to this rate hike. We need real over oversight and billing transparency. We also need consumer protections, including a ban on winter shutoffs, and real debt relief programs for pandemic era errors. And we need a utility that sees its job as a public service not just as a profit engine for their shareholders.

This rate hike -- just to conclude, this rate hike is not just another number on a bill, it's another burden on people who are already drowning in bills. Thank you so much.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Thank you. Thank you for your comments. I have received no other speaker registration cards. Is there anyone else who would like to speak this evening? Okay. It is 6:10. We are going to leave this hearing open for another half an hour. So we will go back on the record at 6:40, and I just want to remind everybody that there are other ways to comment, as I mentioned if you would like your comments known but don't want to make a -- don't want to speak on the record this evening.

Okay. So we will go off the record,

and we'll come back on around 6:40. Thank you. Or if anyone wants to speak, let us know. Thank you.

(Off the record)

A.L.J. KERSEY: We are back on the record. I received no further speaker registration cards and, prior to going on the record, I polled those present to see if anyone intended to make a statement, and no one indicated a wish to speak. Again, you may submit comments regarding these proceedings by the other means described earlier. You must do so my November 21st, 2025, for those comments to be considered. I want to thank everyone for their participation today. This hearing is concluded, and we are off the record. Thanks. Have a great evening.

(The hearing concluded at 6:40 p.m.)

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I, ILDIKO NYARI, do hereby certify that the foregoing was reported by me, in the cause, at the time and place, as stated in the caption hereto, at Page 1 hereof; that the foregoing typewritten transcription consisting of pages 1 through 10, is a true record of all proceedings had at the hearing.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto subscribed my name, this the 14th day of July, 2025.

ILDIKO NYARI, Reporter